

Moving AND monsters

Leonardo grew up in a time of great learning and discovery across western Europe. This period became known as the Renaissance.

Renaissance means “rebirth.” Before this, the last 900 years (a period of time called the Dark Ages) had seen little progress, but during the Renaissance everything changed. Huge advances were made across different areas of civilization—including science, medicine, literature, and art.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Peace of Lodi lasted for 40 years, until Italy was invaded by the French, setting off a fresh round of disputes.

In Italy, the pace of change quickened once the disputes between the different city-states had ended. A treaty known as the Peace of Lodi was signed in 1454, when Leonardo was two years old.